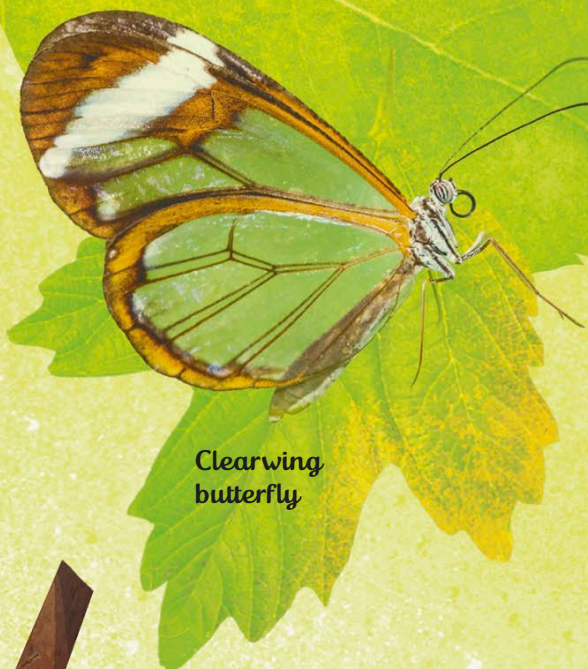


In disguise

Bugs are small, making them seem like easy targets for predators. Luckily, over time, these masters of disguise have developed **cunning ways to hide in plain sight.**



Clearwing butterfly

Leaf insect



Dead leaf mantis



Almost invisible

Not content with only looking similar to their surroundings, some bugs are transparent (see-through).

The clearwing butterfly has transparent wings, which means animals look straight through it.

Blending in

Camouflaged bugs can creep through their habitats undetected because they look like their surroundings. It makes it more difficult for attackers to find them.

Being disguised as a leaf isn't always a good thing, though. Some **leaf insects** are mistaken for food by hungry herbivores!

Horsehead grasshopper



Thorn bug



Groups of **thorn bugs** look like they are part of the plants or branches they sit on.

The giant **swallowtail caterpillar** is often mistaken for bird poop!

